ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 6: **Mijbil the Otter (First Flight)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(b)** a source of comic understatement and character revelation	It shows character and fuels humour.
2	**(b)** adapted to life in and near water	Adaptation.
3	**(d)** Splashing happily, Mij flooded the floor.	Correct participial phrase.
4	**(c)** love for an animal versus the animal's wild needs	Core dilemma.
5	**(a)** respect and patience, not force	Moral.
6	**(a)** handled problems without fuss	Idiom meaning.
7	**(b)** less comic escape, but greater safety	Counterfactual reasoning.
8	**(a)** understatement	Understatement.
9	**(b)** antonyms	Opposites.
10	**(d)** wild instinct and human order	Instinct versus control.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	The animal is removed from its natural home and exposed to stress (1), yet the author's care and affection partly offset the concern (1).	1+1
12	They react with fear and alarm (1), showing that ignorance breeds anxiety (1).	1+1
13	A wild creature in aircraft and apartments looks comic and out of place (1), highlighting the gap between nature and human spaces (1).	1+1
14	Humour makes the risk seem small (1), prompting readers to forgive the lapse more than they would in a sombre account (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Affection motivates the journey and ensures good care (1). Yet the animal's welfare required better safeguards (1). The incident shows love needs prudence to be responsible (1).	1+1+1
16	It leaves the reader with an image of happiness (1). It confirms that Mij is at home with Maxwell (1). It balances earlier tension with relief (1).	1+1+1
17	We learn his patience and humour (1). The incidents test his character (1). Mij is the centre, but Maxwell's reactions colour every scene (1).	1+1+1
	OR: The chaos is described as a spectacle, not as cruelty (1). The otter's actions are seen as natural, not wicked (1). The laughter is at the situation, not at Mij (1).	1+1+1
18	He gives him a name and character (1). He records personal habits and moods (1). This invites readers to feel empathy (1).	1+1+1
	OR: It shows kindness bringing trust (1). It shows laughter instead of anger at mischief (1). It encourages respect for living creatures (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Mij teaches Maxwell patience through chaos (1). He shows that play is a form of intelligence (1). He reveals the nature of otters (1). He tests assumptions about control over nature (1). Thus Mij educates his owner and the reader (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Setting and characters (1). Appearance of the animal (1). Crowd's panic (1). Calm action of the hero (1). Warm closing line (1).	2+2+1

20	Each crisis is retold with a smile (1). Humour reduces fear and embarrassment (1). It allows him to stay calm and help the otter (1). It also invites readers to share his affection (1). Humour thus becomes both coping skill and narrative technique (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Verbs such as darting and tearing give speed (1). Understatement adds wit (1). Images of water give atmosphere (1). Direct description makes Mij individual (1). Together they create a lasting picture (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Calling the pet a dog; **Mijbil** is an otter from the marshes of Iraq, taken to London by **Gavin Maxwell**.
- Mixing *Mij* with the author; 'Mij' is only the pet's short name; the author is Maxwell, whose book is **Ring of Bright Water**.
- Forgetting the aeroplane incident: Mij escaped from his box in the plane and caused a commotion before being caught.
- Writing that Mij disliked water; he loved **water**, playing with it in the bath and with rubber toys; give these as proof of an otter's nature.
- Saying the author handled the otter with force; he is patient and learns the otter's moods through **play and care**.
- Spelling slips: *otter, marsh, Basra, Camusfearna, affectionate*; and tense mixing in a narrative summary.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 6: **Mijbil the Otter (First Flight)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(c)** more fearful and less affectionate	Perspective changes tone.
2	**(b)** personification	Water given human action.
3	**(a)** show how people react to the unfamiliar and add comedy	They are a comic foil to Maxwell's calm.
4	**(b)** Wildness, Warmth and Wit	Captures themes.
5	**(d)** to dramatise the clash between wildness and civilisation	Dramatic purpose.
6	**(b)** He observes the animal sympathetically and with humour	Tone and stance.
7	**(b)** exuberant	Exuberant = full of energy.
8	**(b)** underestimated the risk to the animal and to others	Evaluation.
9	**(c)** comic consequence of instinct	Instinct leads to funny outcomes.
10	**(a)** If Maxwell had used a stronger box, the otter would not have escaped.	Third conditional pattern.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	It would record behaviour in neutral terms (1) and omit the humour and emotion of Maxwell's account (1).	1+1
12	A sturdier container with an attendant (1), because the original box failed under the otter's strength (1).	1+1
13	It shifts the story from preparation to action (1) and tests Maxwell's patience and the otter's nature (1).	1+1
14	Small mishaps follow one another (1) but none leads to real harm, keeping the tone light (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	A box, a plane and a flat cannot contain the otter's instincts (1). Every plan is disrupted by his energy (1). Humans must work with nature rather than command it (1).	1+1+1
16	The otter behaved with great exuberance in the bath and left the floor flooded (1). Formal vocabulary replaces informal phrases (1). The meaning is retained while the register is raised (1).	1+1+1
17	The comic and dramatic effect of the escape (1). The contrast between wildness and civilisation (1). The sense that Mij is a surprising intruder (1).	1+1+1
	OR: The passengers see a threat (1). Maxwell sees a friend (1). Knowledge and affection explain the difference (1).	1+1+1
18	Maxwell was amazed when the otter broke the weak box (1). 'When' creates a subordinate clause (1). The three ideas are linked logically (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Their fear is natural (1). Maxwell sees the humour in the situation (1). His tolerance matches his attitude to Mij (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Introduction stating the question (1). Maxwell's gentleness shows friendship (1). Transporting the otter shows human control (1). The balance depends on respect (1). Conclusion with your view (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Greeting and stand (1). Natural habitat needs (1). Risks in the chapter itself (1). Alternatives such as sanctuaries (1). Closing appeal (1).	2+2+1
20	Format and address (1). Description of the incident (1). Request for rules on animal passengers (1). Maxwell's polite reply acknowledging the trouble (1). Assurance of better precautions (1).	2+2+1

	OR: Maxwell: affection and patience (1). Passengers: alarm mixed with curiosity (1). Air-hostess: practical help (1). Difference comes from knowledge and closeness (1). Conclusion: understanding grows through contact (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Calling the pet a dog; **Mijbil** is an otter from the marshes of Iraq, taken to London by **Gavin Maxwell**.
- Mixing *Mij* with the author; 'Mij' is only the pet's short name; the author is Maxwell, whose book is **Ring of Bright Water**.
- Forgetting the aeroplane incident: Mij escaped from his box in the plane and caused a commotion before being caught.
- Writing that Mij disliked water; he loved **water**, playing with it in the bath and with rubber toys; give these as proof of an otter's nature.
- Saying the author handled the otter with force; he is patient and learns the otter's moods through **play and care**.
- Spelling slips: *otter, marsh, Basra, Camusfearna, affectionate*; and tense mixing in a narrative summary.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 6: **Mijbil the Otter (First Flight)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** Otters are semi-aquatic mammals.	Facts are verifiable.
2	**(b)** He felt secure with Maxwell	The evidence is his ease with the author.
3	**(c)** He was too patient to lose his temper.	'too ... to' conveys the sense with a negative result.
4	**(d)** full of joy and spontaneity	Celebration of nature's vitality.
5	**(d)** Mij's capacity to transform surroundings through play	Metaphor of playground.
6	**(a)** was	Verb should be 'were'.
7	**(c)** vivid characterisation and humour	Craft.
8	**(b)** provide a larger travel space and familiar objects	Practical improvement.
9	**(b)** He asked where the otter was.	Statement word order in reported question.
10	**(c)** Maxwell's calm handling of the otter	Moral.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Trust grows from gentle repeated treatment (1), and Mij's calm in Maxwell's arms shows its power (1).	1+1
12	He accepts affection and lives in a human home (1) but his instincts for water and play remain untamed (1).	1+1
13	Water stands for the otter's freedom and joy (1) and for the natural world that cannot be fully contained (1).	1+1
14	A playful animal calls for lively, warm narration (1), which a solemn tone would spoil (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	In the marshes he had freedom and natural food (1). In London he has affection but limited space (1). On balance, the wild home seems better though Maxwell's care mitigates the loss (1).	1+1+1
16	Mij was in his element in the bath (1). Maxwell took the floods and the fuss in his stride (1). The meanings: perfectly at ease; handle calmly (1).	1+1+1
17	A simple name signals a friendly narrative (1). It suggests an animal-centred account (1). It prepares readers for light, affectionate storytelling (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Each solution fails or creates a new complication (1). The escalation from box to cabin to bath is steady (1). The rising chaos produces comic effect (1).	1+1+1
18	Images of spraying water and a diving body create movement (1). The sound of splashing is almost audible (1). The reader shares the otter's delight (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Friendship need not depend on language or species (1). It grows from patience and shared joy (1). Mij and Maxwell prove this (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Preparation sets expectations of safety (1). The flight breaks them with comedy (1). The air-hostess's help shows the crisis handled with humour (1). The flat resolves the story in joy (1). The stages build a rising and then settling rhythm (1).	2+2+1
	OR: A possible ending shows search and anxiety (1). The tone turns from comic to worried (1). The theme shifts to responsibility (1). The bond remains but is tested harder (1). Maxwell's original ending is lighter and more hopeful (1).	2+2+1
20	Mij adapts to a human home (1). He forms a loving bond (1). Yet he needs water and space (1). The chapter shows possibility and limits (1). It leaves the moral choice to the reader (1).	2+2+1
	OR: It observes the animal's real habits (1). It conveys joy without sentimentality (1). It combines humour with accurate detail (1). It respects the animal's wildness (1). It encourages readers to value wildlife (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Calling the pet a dog; **Mijbil** is an otter from the marshes of Iraq, taken to London by **Gavin Maxwell**.
- Mixing *Mij* with the author; 'Mij' is only the pet's short name; the author is Maxwell, whose book is **Ring of Bright Water**.
- Forgetting the aeroplane incident: Mij escaped from his box in the plane and caused a commotion before being caught.
- Writing that Mij disliked water; he loved **water**, playing with it in the bath and with rubber toys; give these as proof of an otter's nature.
- Saying the author handled the otter with force; he is patient and learns the otter's moods through **play and care**.
- Spelling slips: *otter, marsh, Basra, Camusfearna, affectionate*; and tense mixing in a narrative summary.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND